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Market Briefs Pro

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Good morning, Pro Briefers!

Americans haven't been to the moon since 1972 - even still, investments into space have taken off in 2025.

Why? Technology has developed to a point where countries and companies can do more in space.

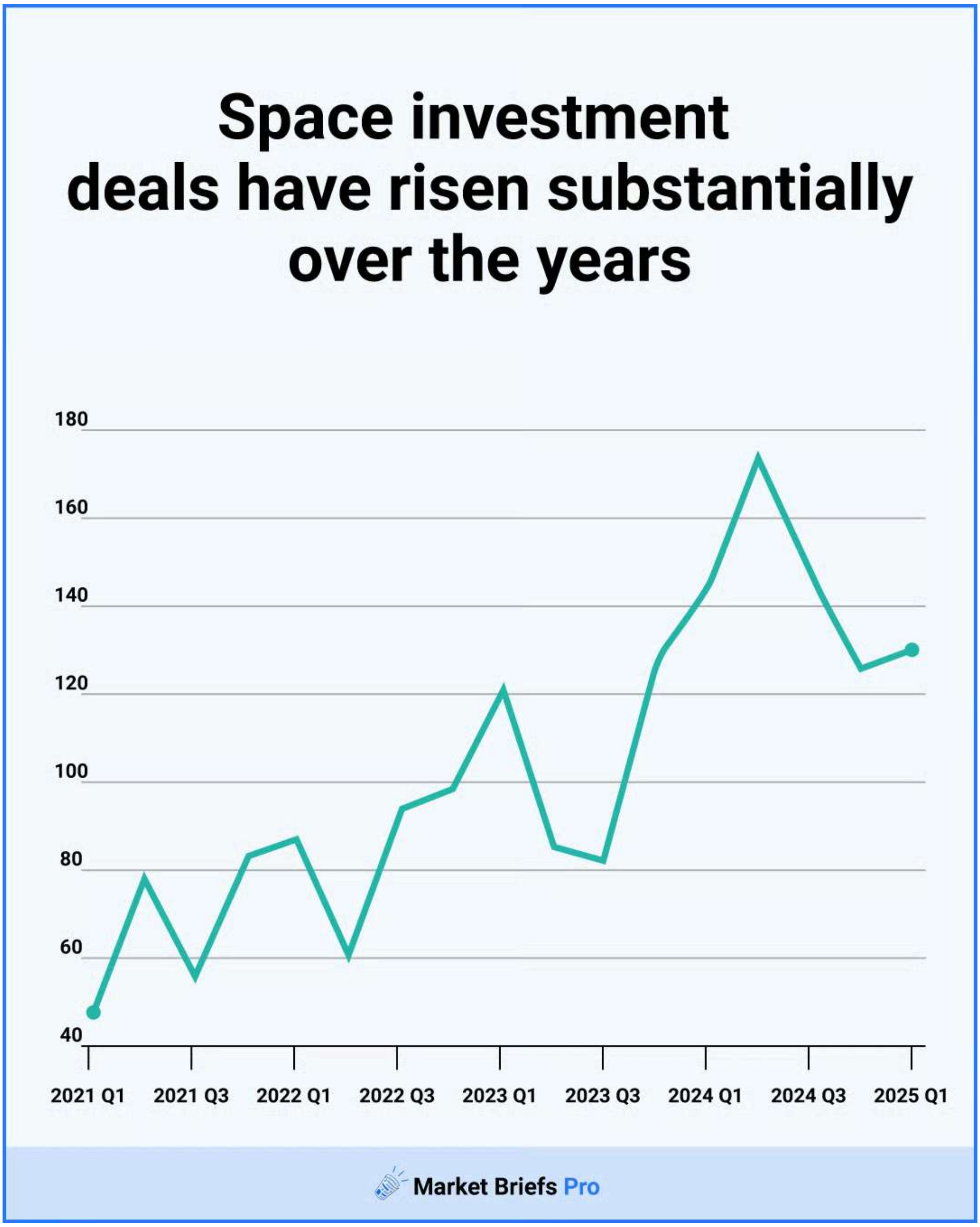
Better tech = increased accessibility.

Commercial developments in space are now taking off, which is where we have identified an Innovation Shift:

The next generation of space tech like space rockets, satellites, and construction companies will see an increase in revenue as the need for space infrastructure grows.

Let's break down why investors may want to make some *space* in their portfolios for these opportunities.

First, what does an investment into space mean?



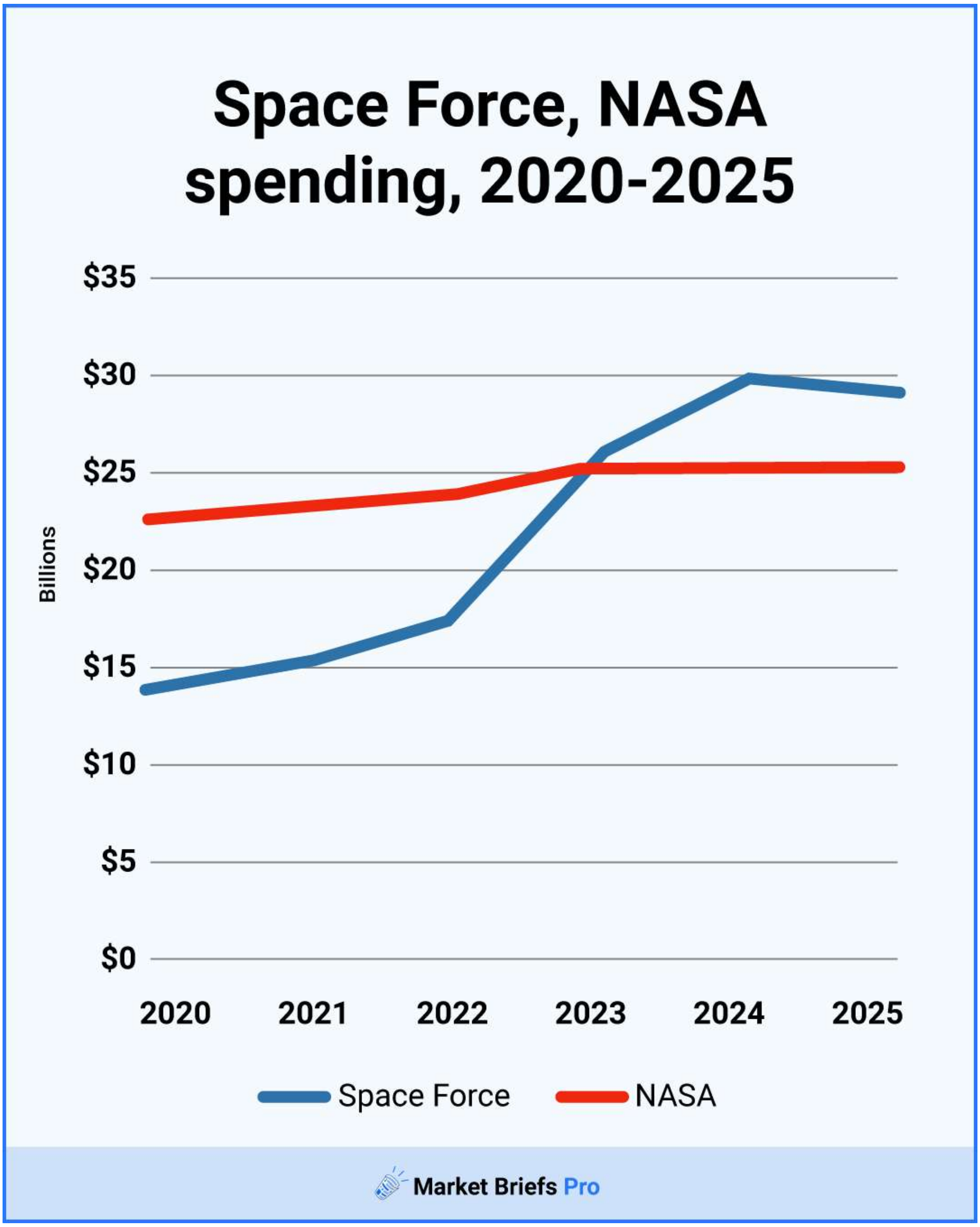
Data via Seraphim Space

Governments and companies are focused on building the infrastructure of space and are spending billions of dollars in order to do it.

- The Space Force, a branch of the U.S. military founded by President Trump in 2019, had a budget of $29 billion in 2024.

This year, the government took its commitment to space one step further - particularly with the passing of The One Big Beautiful Bill Act.

The Bill increased NASA's budget by $10 billion and President Trump's Golden Dome executive order also instructed the Defense Department to create a plan for defense systems in space.



Data via NASA

- NASA's budget has been flat until this year.

Still not convinced? Look no further than our markets.

Firefly (FLY) had one of the biggest IPO launches earlier this year - the company raised $868 million in a single day *(more on them later)*.

The bottom line: The space economy is growing - and spending is now shifting into the companies that are building space infrastructure for satellites, defense systems, data centers, and more.

That's allowing businesses within the space infrastructure industry to grow - and as they grow, investors may be able to profit.

ANALYST TAKEAWAYS

Tickers we're tracking:

Rockets: FLY, RKLB
Satellites: PL, ASTS
Construction: LUNR, LDOS

We went deeper into the research - check out our full deepdive here.

ROCKETS

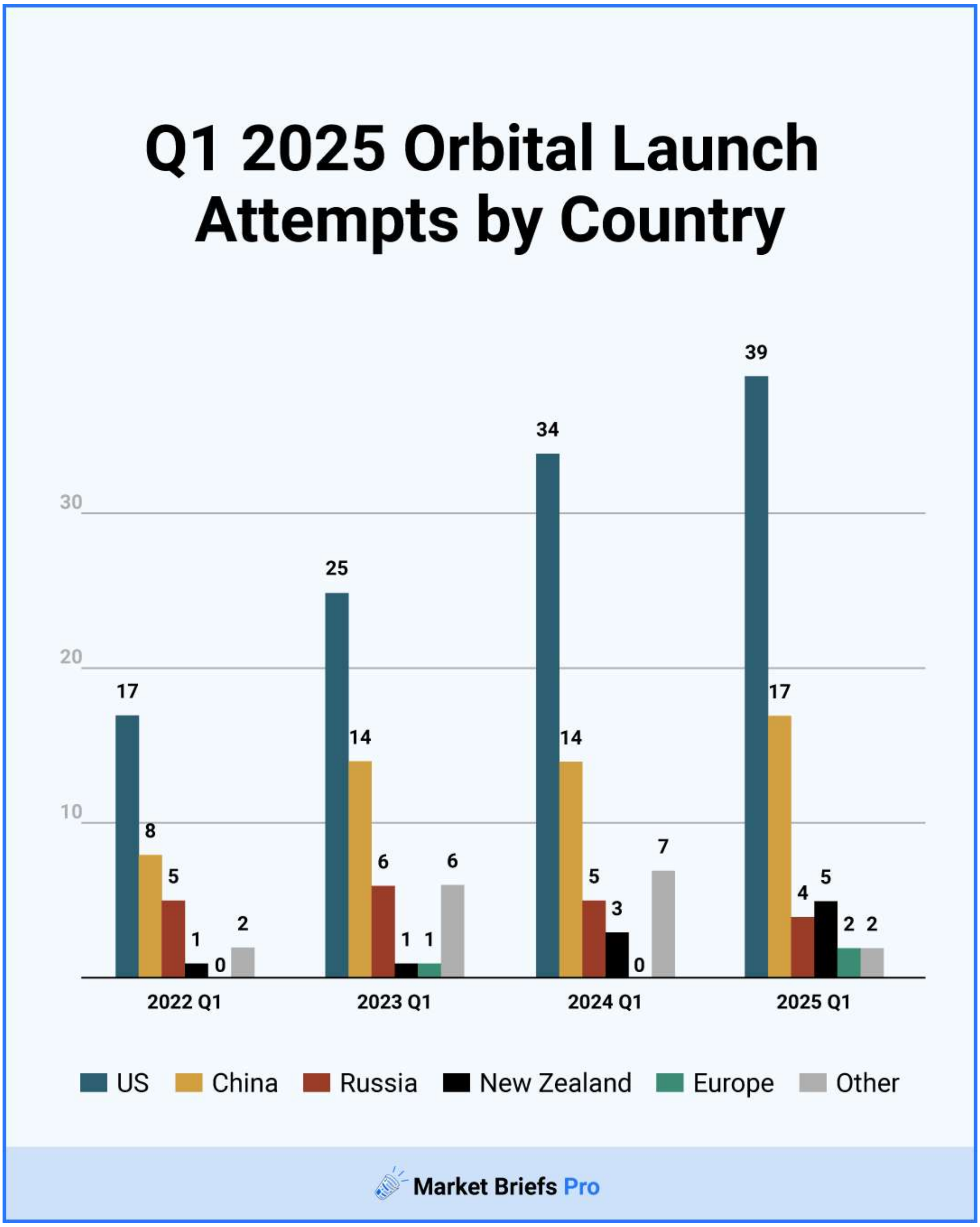
Launching Into Space

In order for companies to build the next generation of space infrastructure, they first have to go to space.

Rockets are really the only option - but sending a rocket to space is expensive.

- Each SpaceX rocket launch costs on average $62 million.

Companies are now looking to reduce those costs in order to run sustainable rocket launch businesses, and more importantly, make money.



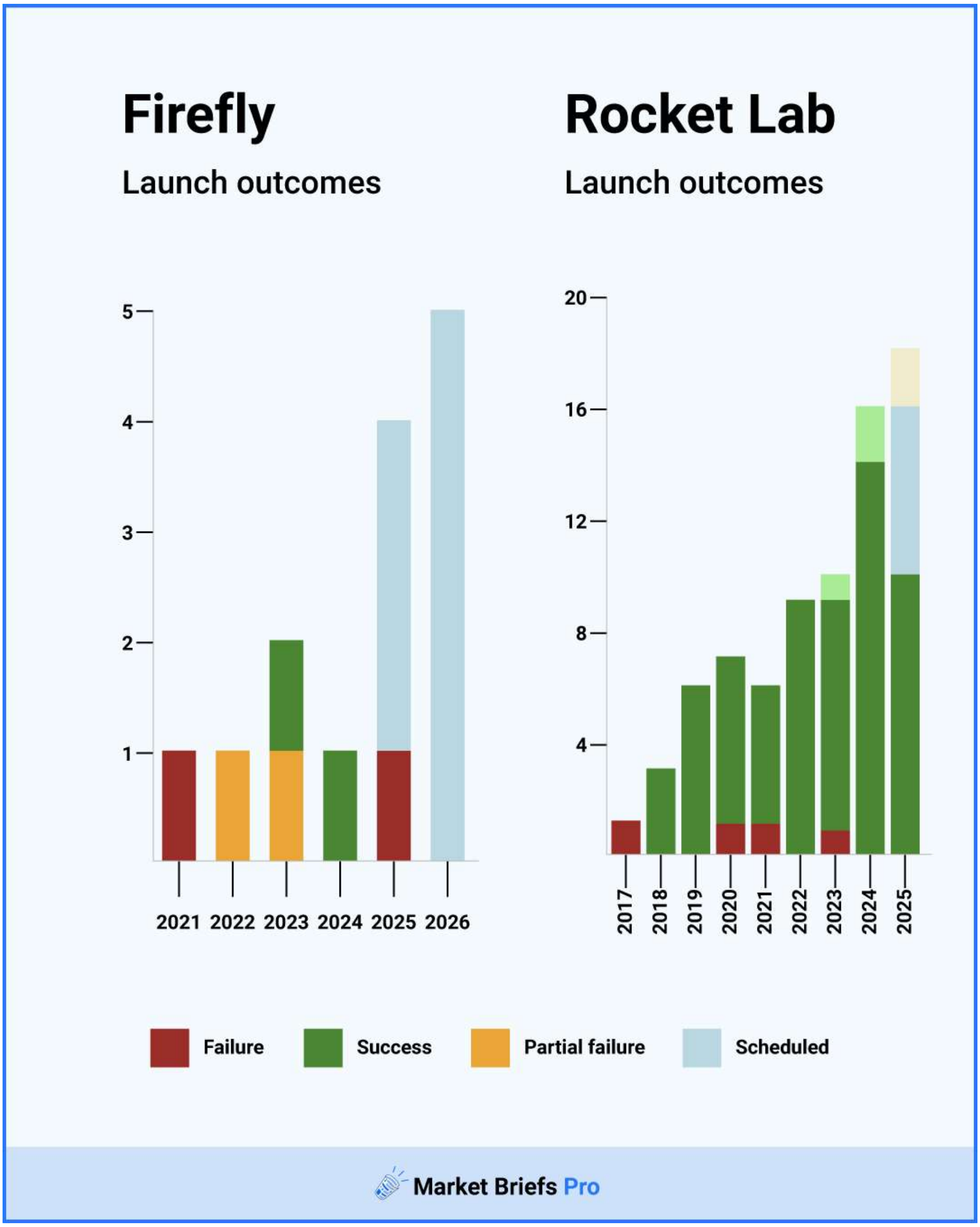
Data via Payload Space

One of those companies is Firefly Aerospace, which is one of the only developers of reusable rockets in the world.

With its tech, it became the first company ever to perform a fully successful soft landing on the Moon.

- Firefly also just landed a $176.7 million NASA contract for a lunar south-pole mission planned for 2029 using its lunar landers.

While there has been some hype on Wall Street and in the space industry around Firefly, they are still unprofitable.

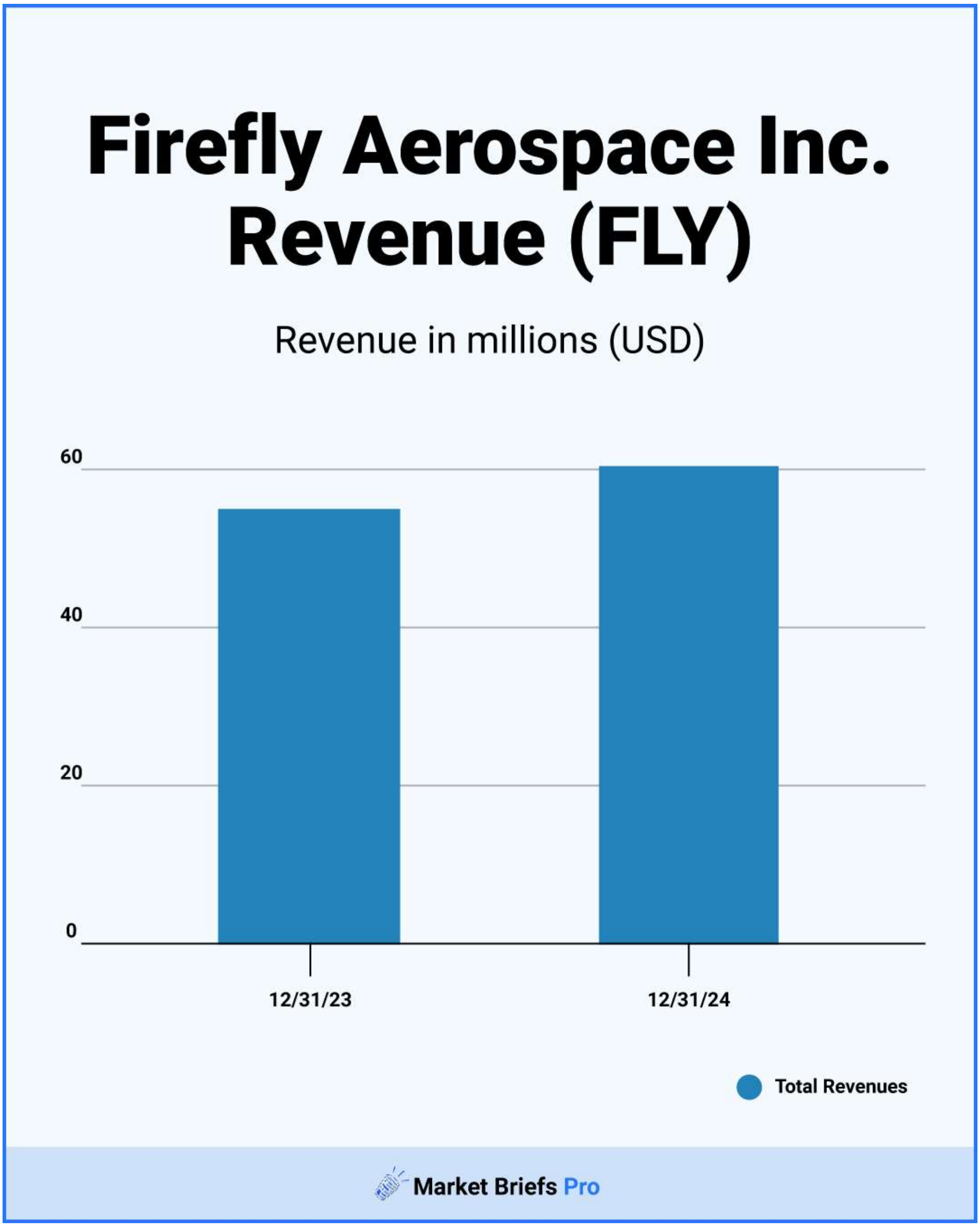


Data via Nanalyze

In 2024, Firefly lost $231 million - in Q1 of 2025, they lost $60 million.

But the company is creating a backlog for its business of over $1.1 billion between current and future contracts, which may help it to become profitable in the future.

Its revenue has also increased - it earned $60.8 million in 2024, a 10% increase year-over-year.



Data via company 10-K

Firefly is the new kid on the block when it comes to space rockets. Rocket Lab (RKLB) is one of the fastest-growing rocket companies in the world.

What do they do? The company has made 68 successful launches, second only to the private space company SpaceX.

Its launches are also some of the fastest in the industry - it had two launches in 48 hours, creating 5 satellite constellations in 2024.

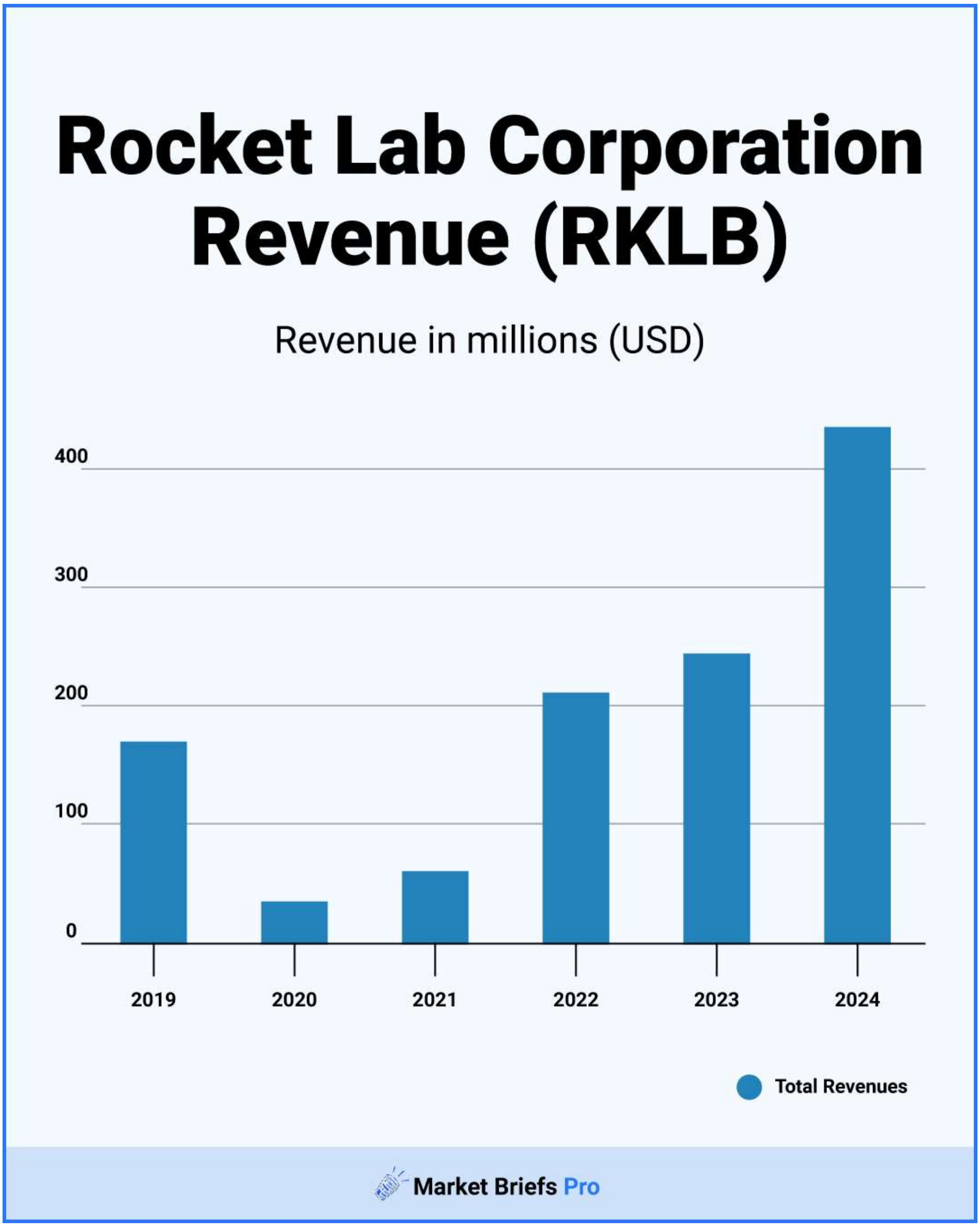
Rocket Lab has also doubled down on its capabilities through acquisitions.

Data via Yahoo! Finance

- In August of 2025, Rocket Lab bought defense company Geost, which makes rocket sensors, for $275 million, diversifying the services it is able to provide.

Its rockets are also partly reusable, which allows it to save some money by recycling parts for new launches.

And while Rocket Labs' revenue did increase by 32% year-over-year in 2025, just like Firefly, it is not yet profitable.



Data via company 10-K

In fact, it lost $190 million in 2024.

So where's the opportunity? Shares of Rocket Lab are up over 72% YTD.

- Government contracts and tech demand are on track to one day lift it to profitability.

There are also ETFs that cover rocket companies and the companies building the tech to help us get to space - one of those is the ARK Space Exploration & Innovation ETF (ARKX).

Data via Yahoo! Finance

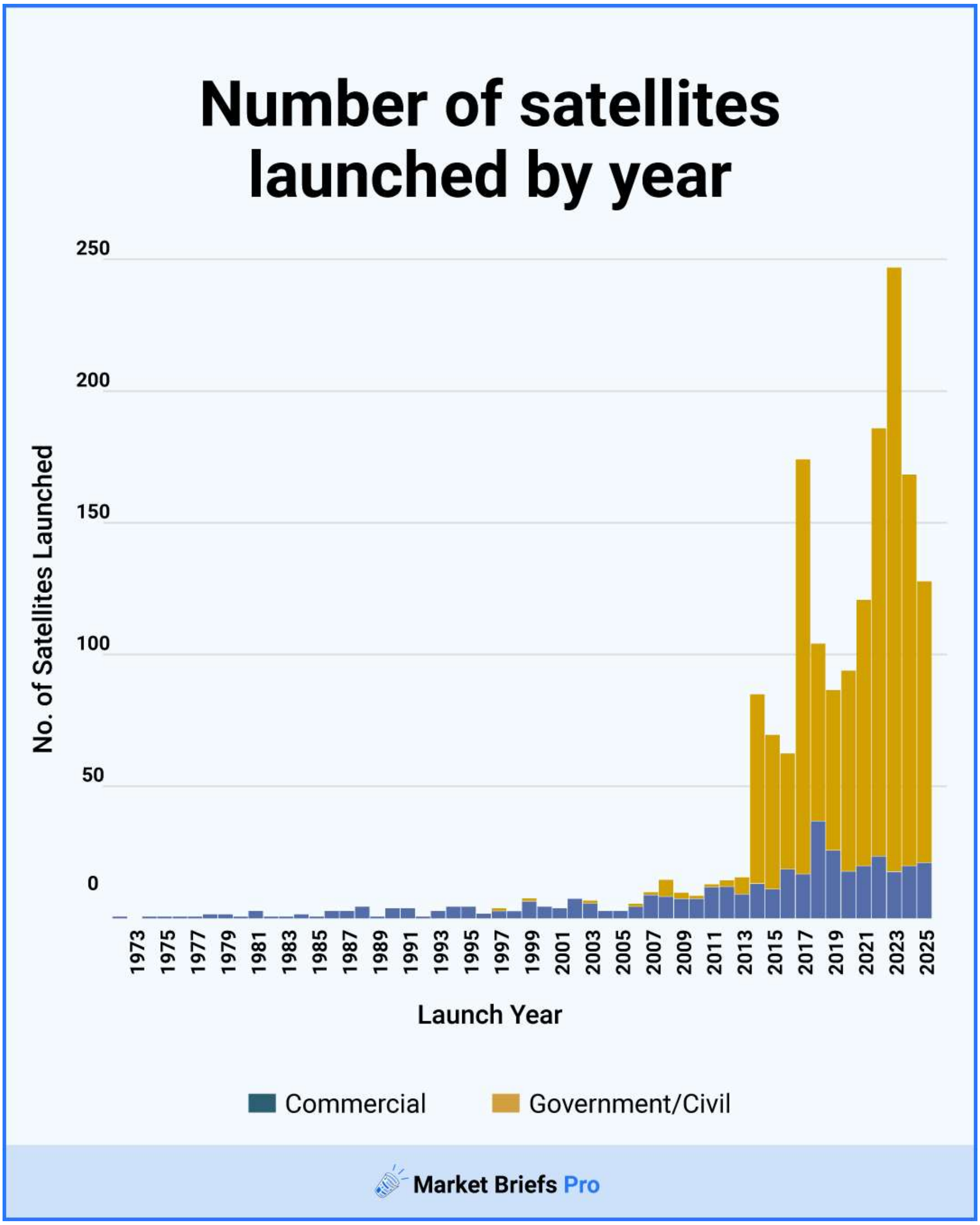
SATELLITES

Tech Above Earth

In 2023, over 150 satellites were launched into space. This year, there have already been over 100 satellites sent to space.

Why? Satellites have emerged as a critical piece of space infrastructure due to their observation, communication, and research capabilities.

The Golden Dome executive order we mentioned before? Creating new satellites is a big part of where federal funding is expected to shift within the next few years.



Data via USGS

And without satellites, things like GPS, the internet, and more could be severely limited.

More satellites are expected to be in space soon as a result, which means satellite companies may directly benefit from this shift.

Planet Labs (PL) operates one of the largest satellite imaging fleets in the galaxy, which captures pictures of our planet daily.

What's the point? Scientists and researchers need these pictures to monitor our planet from afar and detect any changes.

It is also the premier satellite imaging company for various governments around the world, including the U.S., E.U., and for NATO.

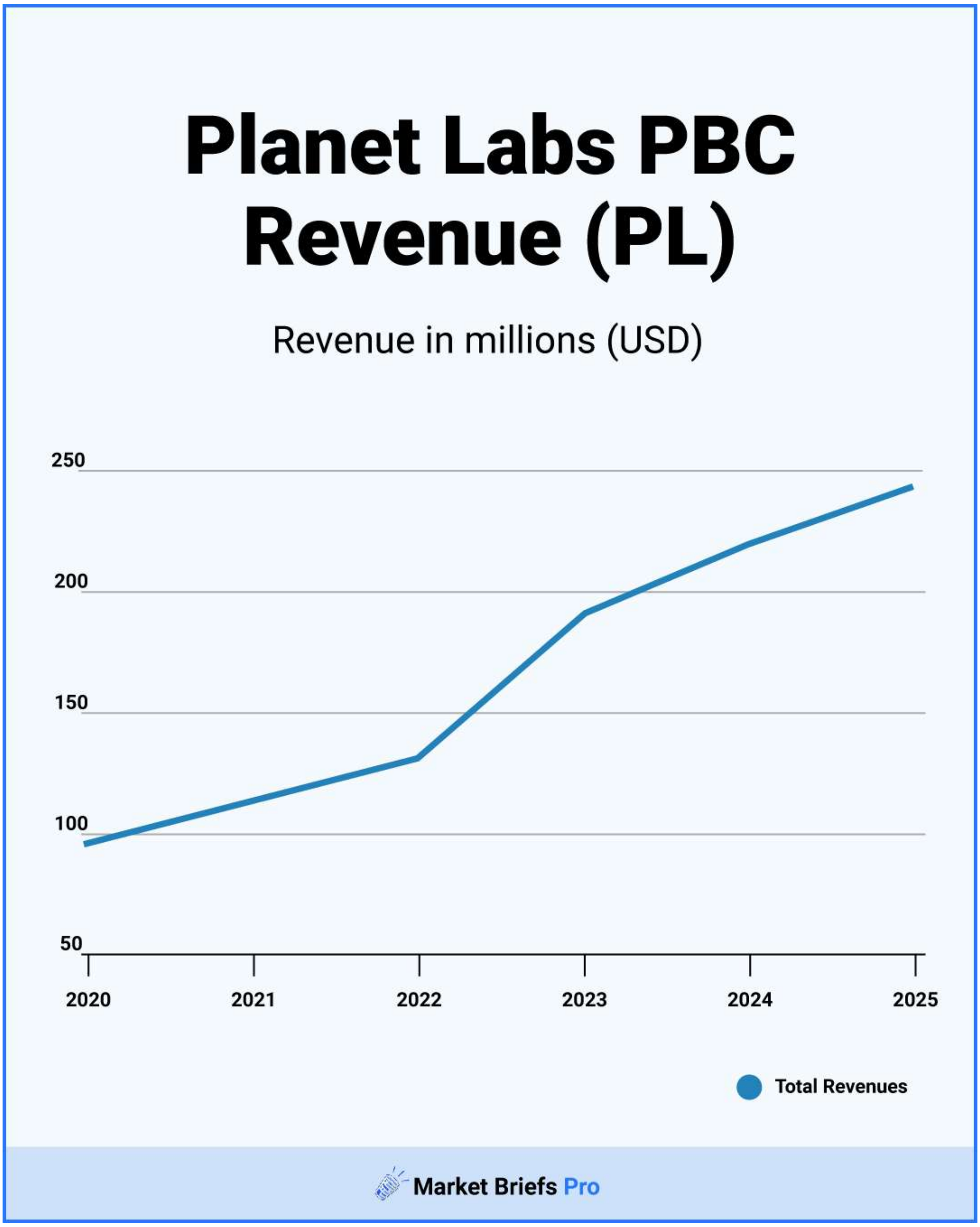
Data via Yahoo! Finance

- It has earned $280 million from the German government alone so far this year.

That's allowed it to step up its efforts as a satellite company - the company has launched over 450 satellites since 2013, and most of them stay in space, reducing costs for Planet Labs.

Only SpaceX and the U.S., China, and U.K. governments have more satellites in space than Planet Labs.

The company also earned $244 million in revenue in 2024 and has even achieved profitability for the first time in 2025.



Data via company 10-K

Satellites can be used for more than just imaging - they are also critical for cell phone networks and our internet.

AST SpaceMobile (ASTS) has created a space-based broadband cellular network, building on past innovations in the field.

In English: Your texts go to space instead of a tower.

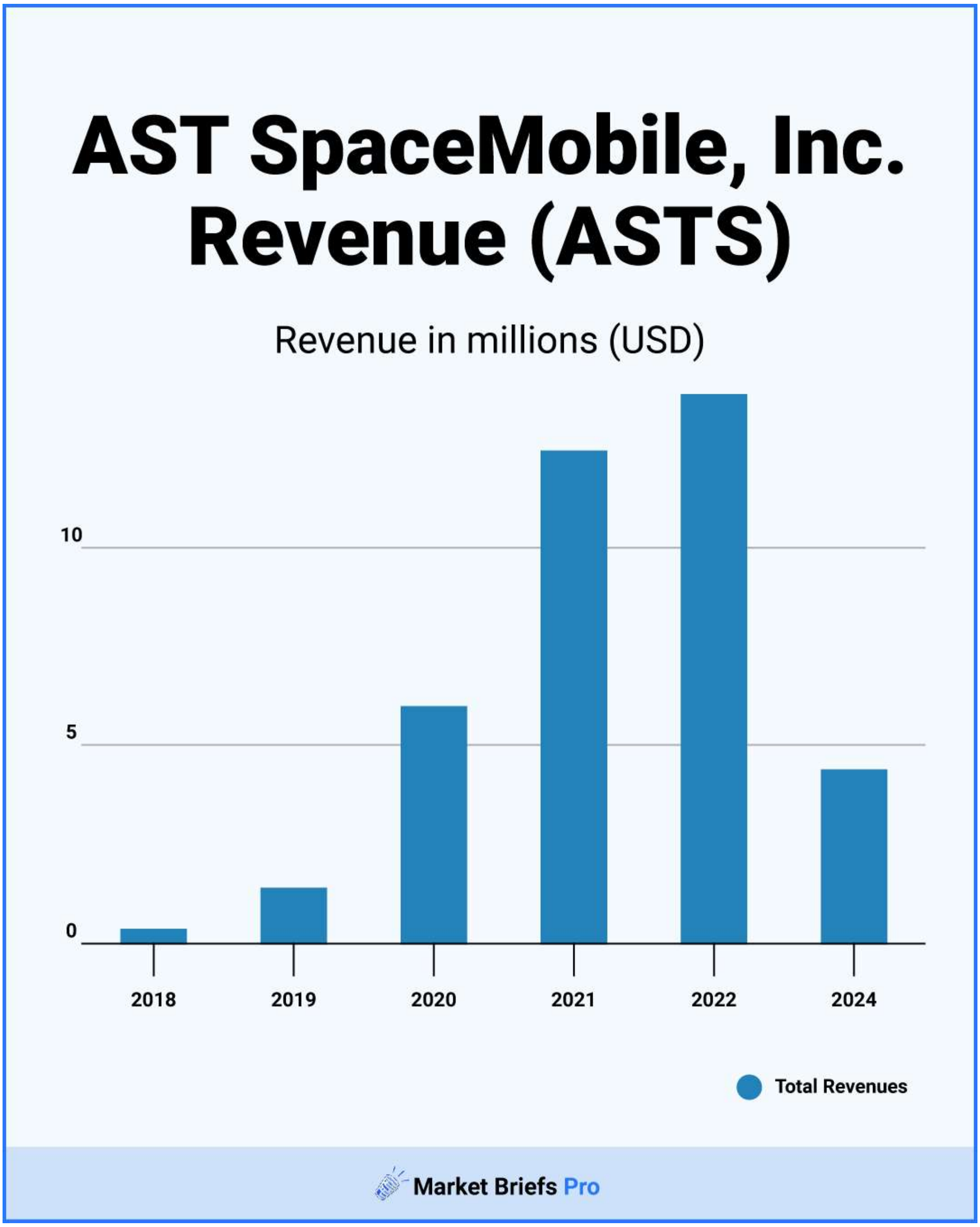
Normally, sending phone service to a tower is much faster and more efficient - but there are places in the world where we can't build cell towers.

Data via Yahoo! Finance

Its service targets these remote areas and can also be used to provide service when cell towers are broken down, such as during disasters.

It has partnered with the top names in tech, too - AT&T and Google are on contract with AST to expand their networks globally.

Keep in mind: AST SpaceMobile isn't profitable yet - in fact, they had zero revenue in 2023, and earned just $4.4 billion in 2024, down from $13 billion in 2022.



Data via company 10-K

This is because the company used 2023 to focus on developing its tech and relaunched its services in 2024.

Investors are hopeful for its future - shares of the company are up over 125% YTD.

The Procure Space ETF (UFO) explores other potential opportunities as well, specifically for those looking to passively invest in companies building satellite tech.

Data via Yahoo! Finance

CONSTRUCTION

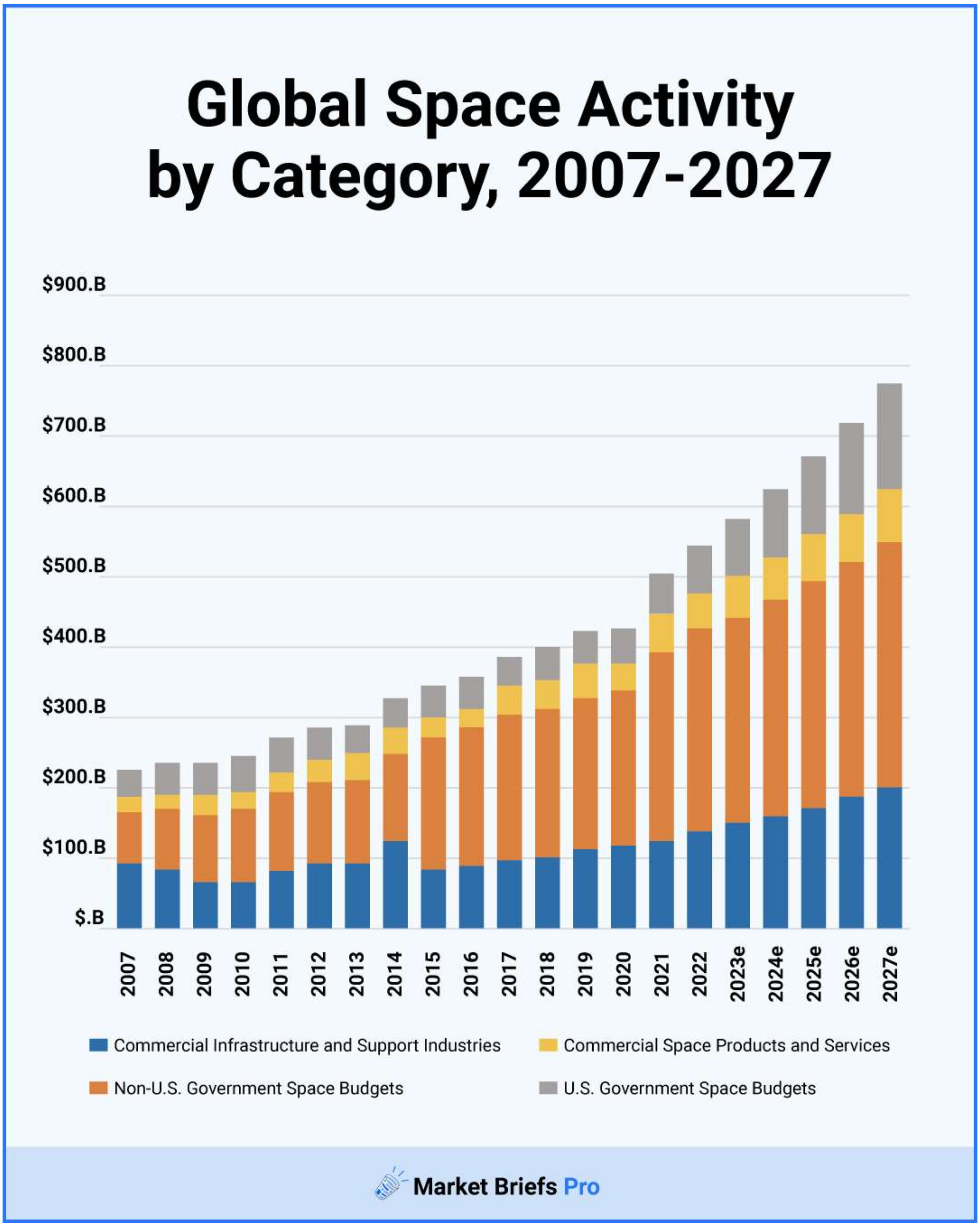
What's Being Built

Up until recently, if you wanted something in space, you had to build it here on Earth, and then launch it up.

Now, businesses are working on new tech that may make building things like data centers or moon bases in space a reality in the future.

How? Robots and construction equipment have advanced enough to make some space construction a reality.

And while companies and governments are not ready to build full cities on the moon just yet, there are some businesses working on innovations that are helping us get there.



Data via Space Foundation Database

One of these companies is Intuitive Machines (LUNR), which is focused on putting equipment and other infrastructure into space and on the moon.

In fact, the company is under contract to help NASA return to the moon.

- The landing of its rover on the moon in 2024 was the first time an object landed on the moon since 1972.

Though what Intuitive Machines specializes in is equipment delivery in space.

Data via Yahoo! Finance

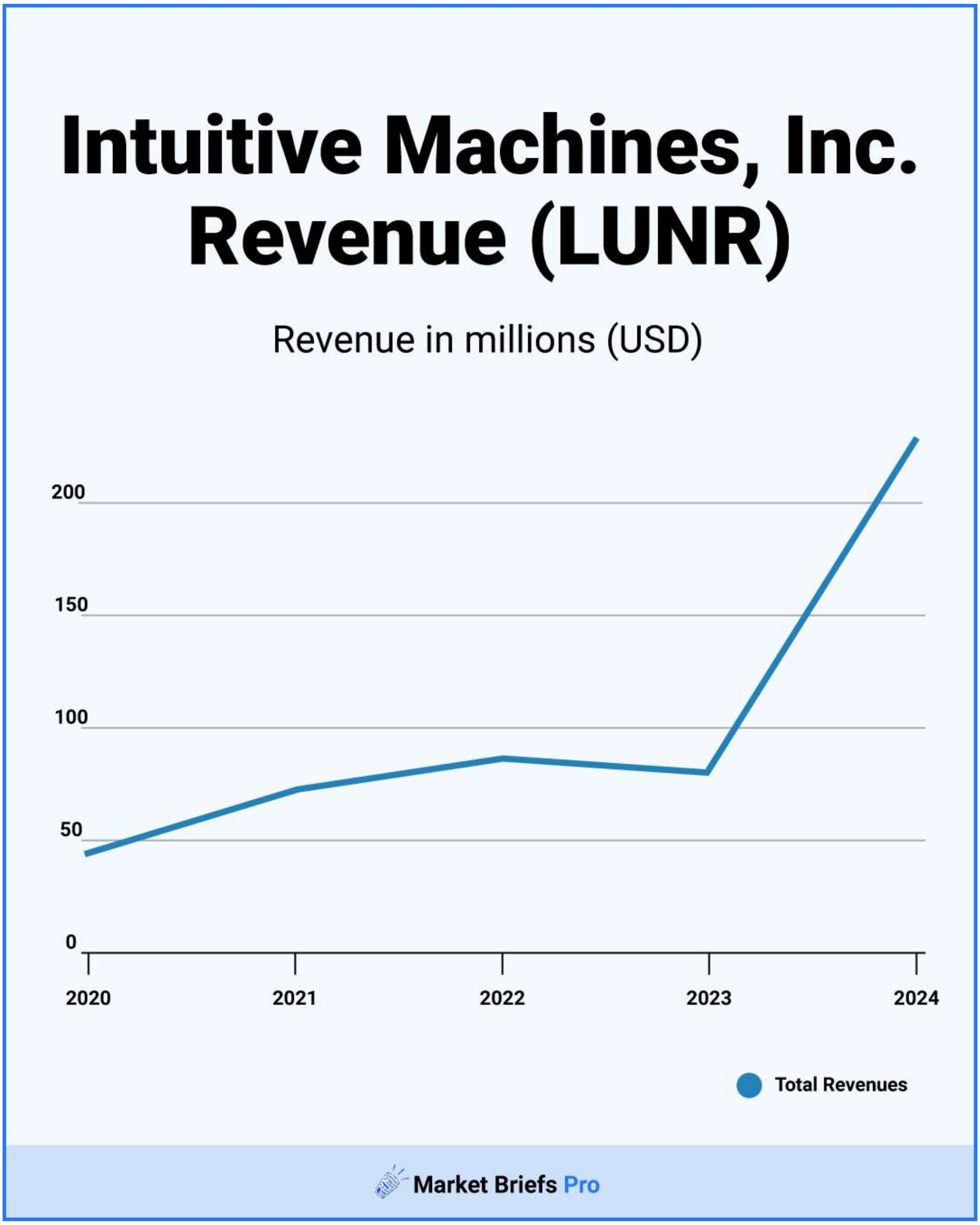
It's one of the only companies that is able to deliver things to the moon, where NASA is actively trying to build.

They saw their revenue jump by more than 250% last year, going from $79 million in 2023 to $228 million in 2024.

It came at a cost - the company was not profitable and lost around $50 million.

Intuitive Machines handles the delivery, but a company like Leidos (LDOS) is a part of the actual building process.

- It's an engineering company that helped put the International Space Station (ISS) into orbit.



Data via company 10-K

Leidos designs, develops, and tests hardware for spacecraft, particularly for NASA, with its current contract with the agency worth $2.5 billion over the next 10 years.

The company also has a long history of integrating its tech into vehicles, which it is now doing for places like the ISS.

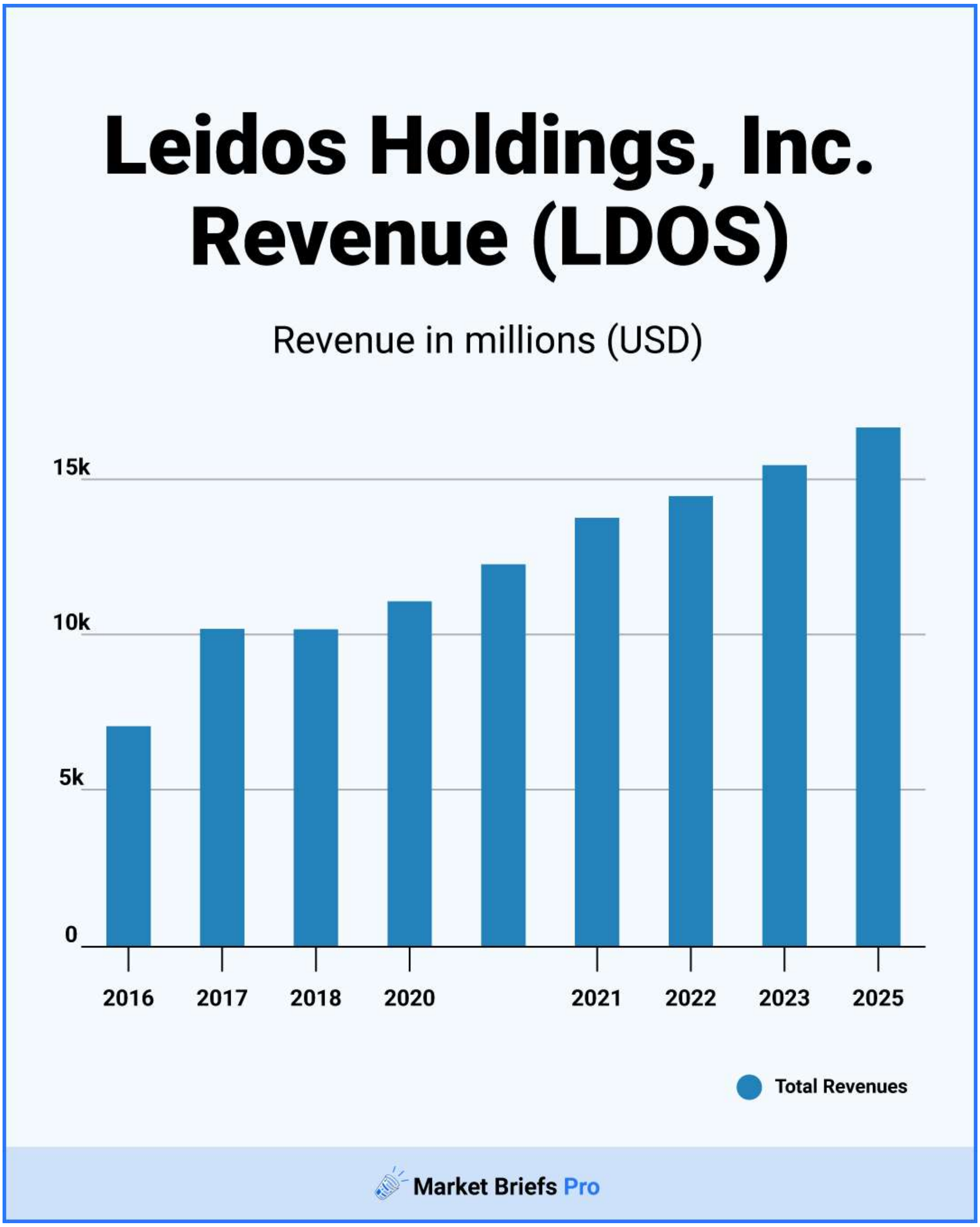
- Vehicles that are built and used on the ISS are built with the help of tech from Leidos.

Full transparency: Leidos is developing space infrastructure, but it is not its main revenue driver as of 2025.

Data via Yahoo! Finance

It is increasing the amount of revenue it earns from space, establishing contacts not just with NASA, but with the U.K. for space infrastructure as well.

That helped it earn $26.6 billion in revenue in 2024, a record, and up from $15.4 billion in 2023.



Data via company 10-K

RISKS

Houston, We Have A Problem

Financial risk is one thing investors will want to consider when thinking about investing in space companies.

Many of these companies are not profitable, and it could take years for them to reach profitability.

In addition, space tech has grown exponentially over the last few decades, and it still has a long way to go before people are living on Mars or the moon.

That means the innovations today could be overshadowed by different innovations in the future, putting the opportunities in this report at risk.

We also just don't know what investment could look like in space in the future.

President Trump's administration has put more emphasis into space, but that may not always be the case.

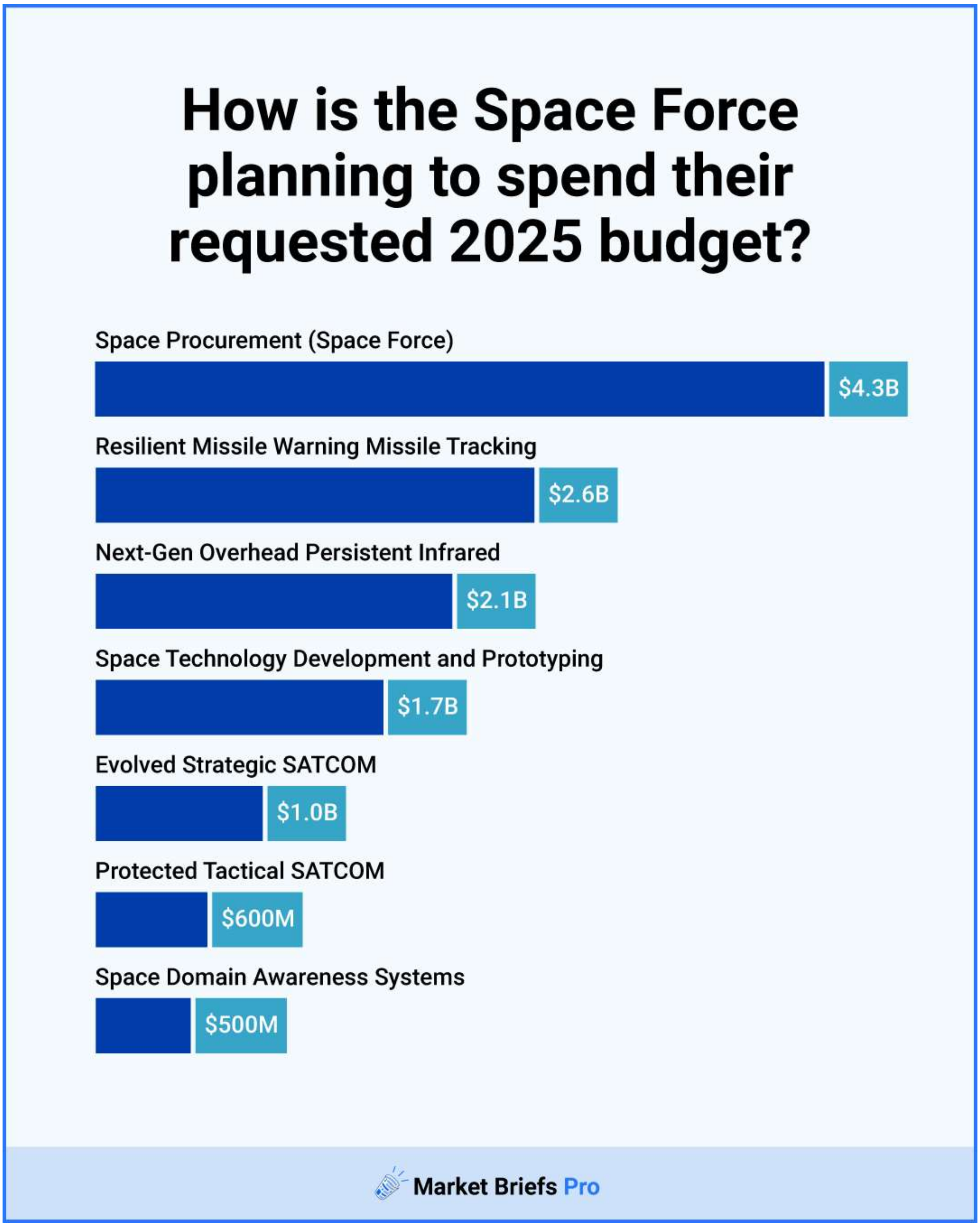
Investors need to know that this is a long-term shift, and while there's a chance space infrastructure investments could grow in the future, there is never a guarantee.

REVIEW

Going To The Moon

Space investments have been going to the moon in recent years - fueled by new technology and investments from VCs and world governments.

There is now a lot of activity going on in space - but in order to sustain it, there needs to be proper infrastructure put in place.



Data via Congressional Research Service

That's leading to an increase in spending into construction, satellites, and rocket companies that are helping to shape the next generation of space infrastructure.

Investors will want to keep an eye on this long-term shift as developments are changing the world outside of our own every day.

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